

Ancient Order of Free Gardeners Inc.: Branding and Communications Guide

This guide establishes the official branding, communication standards, and visual identity for the Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, Inc. (AOFG). All lodges, grand lodges, officers, and members must follow these standards to maintain consistency, professionalism, and unity across the Order.

1. Official AOFG Color Scheme: Primary Deep Blues

These colors form the foundation of the palette and work well for formal branding, regalia, headers, and official documents.

Deep Navy Blue (United Council Seal)

- Hex: #002147
- RGB: 0, 33, 71
- HSL: 212°, 100%, 14%

Royal Midnight Blue (A.O.F.G.)

- Hex: #003876
- RGB: 0, 56, 118
- HSL: 212°, 100%, 23%

Gold Accent Tones

These provide contrast, warmth, and ceremonial emphasis.

Antique Gold (United Council Seal)

- Hex: #d5b745
- RGB: 213, 183, 69
- HSL: 48°, 63%, 55%

Bright Harvest Gold (A.O.F.G.)

- Hex: #f4c726
- RGB: 244, 199, 38
- HSL: 47°, 90%, 55%

Neutral Foundation

White is essential for balance, clarity, and contrast.

White

- Hex: #FFFFFF
- RGB: 255, 255, 255
- HSL: 0°, 0%, 100%

Usage Guidelines

- Royal Midnight Blue and White should be used as the primary identity colors.
- White and Gold may be used for accents, borders, or backgrounds.
- Avoid using off-brand colors for official documents or graphics.

2. Logo Usage Standards: Approved Logos

- The official AOFG Logo
- The AOFG Square, Compass, and Pruning Knife emblem
- Lodge-specific logos that include:
 - The name or abbreviation of the Order (Ancient Order of Free Gardeners or A.O.F.G.)
 - Lodge name and number
 - Traditional symbols (square, compass, pruning knife, letters A S N O)

Logo Rules

- Do not stretch, distort, recolor, remove or replace parts the logo.
- Use only approved color versions: full color, black, or white.
- Do not place the logo over busy backgrounds.
- Lodge logos must never replace or override the official AOFG logo in formal documents.

Campaign Slogans and Hashtags: Approved Slogans

- Cultivating the Garden Within
- Fellowship, Charity, Growth
- Rooted in Tradition, Growing Toward the Future

- Grow With Us
- Cultivating a Better World
- Sowing Seed of Kindness
- Step Beyond the Gate
- Brotherhood Awaits Beyond the Gate

Approved Hashtags

- #AOFG
- #AncientOrderOfFreeGardeners
- #FreeGardeners
- #GrowWithUse
- #[LodgeName]Lodge[Number]
- #AOFGLegacy

Hashtags should be used consistently across Facebook, Instagram, and other platforms.

4. Name Placement and Abbreviations

Full Name: Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, Inc.

Abbreviation: A.O.F.G. or A.O.F.G. Inc.

Placement Standards

- On formal documents: use the full name on first reference, abbreviation thereafter.
- On social media: abbreviation may be used in account names; full name must appear in the bio or description.
- On regalia, banners, and printed materials: either full name or abbreviation is acceptable, but must be consistent.

5. Letterhead Standards

Required Elements

- Official AOFG Lodge Header at the top center
- Official United Council Header at the top center (United Council only)

- Full name: Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, Inc.
- Lodge name and number (if lodge-specific)
- Mailing address (PO Box or physical lodge address if applicable)
- Lodge email address
- Website: www.thefreegardeners.org

Optional Elements

- Motto or slogan
- Lodge charter date

Letterhead must use the AOFG color scheme and approved font (recommended: Times New Roman for formal documents; Arial or Calibri for digital communications).

6. Standard Email and Letter Greetings

Formal Greetings

- Dear Brother,
- Dear Sister,
- Dear Seeker,
- Dear Members of the Ancient Order of Free Gardeners,

Neutral Greetings

- Greetings,
- Good day,

Closings

- With Floral Greetings, *(for formal communications with members only)*
- Warm Regards, *(for communications with public)*

Signature Block Format

[Full Name]

[Title or Office]

[Lodge Name] Lodge No. [Number]

Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, Inc.

[lodge email] (*for letters only*)

[phone number, if appropriate]

7. Setting Email Signatures in Gmail

Steps

1. Open Gmail.
2. Click the gear icon (Settings) in the upper right.
3. Select “See all settings.”
4. Scroll to the “Signature” section.
5. Click “Create new.”
6. Enter the signature block using the standard format above.
7. Set the signature as default for new emails and replies.
8. Save changes at the bottom of the page.

Signature Formatting Rules

- Use black text only.
- Do not include personal quotes, emojis, or unrelated images.
- Social Media Icons should be included in emails after the website link (copy from AOFG email template)
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8. Email Templates for Common Communications

A. Response to Membership Inquiry (use **AOFG Interest Email Template)**

- Attach copy of **AOFG Membership App -UC**
- Attach copy of **AOFG Flyer**
- Attach copy of **AOFG Organizational Chart**

B. Meeting Announcement

Use **AOFG Meeting Announcement** template

C. Event or Service Project Announcement

Use **AOFG Event Announcement** template

**Use approved slogans and hashtags when posting online.*

D. Official Lodge Correspondence

- Use letterhead.
- Use formal greeting and closing.
- Maintain professional tone.
- Avoid personal opinions or informal language.

**Approved Templates can be standardized into a shared Drive folder (i.e. Google, One Drive, etc.) for lodge officers.*